







WHERE
Bastian Beach Club; Ground Floor, Sun-n-Sand Hotel, Juhu.

COST
₹10,000 for a couple.
Pool Access:
₹2,000 per person.

the sand is very real. "People come dressed up and don't want to venture onto the actual beach," Bindra explains with a grin. "So we brought the sand to them. They can sit with their feet in the grains, watch the sunset, and thankfully, the AQI has been on our side lately."

The people he is referring to is the glossy 'it' set, dressed not for the weather, but for the algorithm. I spent a good portion of the afternoon watching couples navigating the sand in precariously high heels with the grace of tightrope walkers, all to capture that perfect, palm-fringed selfie at the pool's edge. One false move and it could be a very expensive splash! The soundtrack to this spectacle jumps from Michael Jackson and Madonna to Bollywood hits and the thumping beats of Keinemusik.

Originals & The Outliers

The food menu features all the hits that built the Bastian empire and a few new additions. We started with the familiar guacamole, spiked with tiger milk and a hit of habanero that wakes up the palate. The shiitake salad is dressed with daidai (Japanese bitter orange) and a nutty tahini-parmesan finish. From the robata section, the asparagus with spicy soy mirin glaze had that perfect char, but the real showstopper was the chicken taco topped with the spicy Peruvian sauce anticuchera. The translucent prawn dim sum and the comforting mac and cheese remain a reliable staple for those not ready to experiment just yet.

The menu comprises all the Bastian classics plus new additions; The indoor dining area (Opposite page)

The cocktails are designed for long, humid afternoons. The Picante with fresh cucumber and pineapple carries a chili rim for that unexpected zing. For a botanical alternative, the gin-based Springhill Cooler uses muddled red grapes and mint. Whisky cocktail Garden Party is a departure from typical beach fare. It's bright and fruit forward but with the clever addition of pepper which gives the whisky a sudden, savoury kick.

With another outpost slated for Marine Drive and a wellness-focused private club arriving in Bandra, the Bastian empire is clearly in a state of aggressive expansion. But for now, this Juhu sanctuary feels like the crown jewel. It offers that rarest of Mumbai luxuries: the ability to feel connected to the elements without actually having to battle them.